

William Fawson, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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Please feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#). For further information, visit my [Website](#).

Summary

My research examines how people navigate hierarchy in organisations. Specifically, I study how hierarchy shapes people's feelings, thoughts, and behaviours at work. My research is currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, has been conditionally accepted at *Nature Human Behaviour* and has been featured in *Forbes* and *Think*. I was recently awarded Early Career Scholar by the *International Association for Conflict Management*.

At London Business School, I teach Personal Assessment & Development, which is a mandatory Leadership course for all students on the Masters in Finance program. I am also a guest lecturer in the Power & Influence MBA elective at IESE Business School, where I earned my PhD.

Before entering academia, I spent seven years working in finance and strategy consulting in London and Amsterdam, and two years as a career mentor in Barcelona. I hold a BSc in Economics and Politics from the University of Bath, an MBA from IESE Business School, and I am a Chartered Accountant in the United Kingdom.

Academic Positions

London Business School – London, United Kingdom	2025-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Advisor: Ena Inesi)	Present

Education

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2021-25
PhD in Management	

- Dissertation: On the Nature, Antecedents and Effects of Status
- Cum Laude (Distinction)
- Advisors: Sebastien Brion, Anneloes Raes
- Committee: Nicholas Hays, Robert Lount, Maya Rossignac-Milon

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2014-16
Master of Business Administration	

Institute of Chartered Accountants of Scotland – Edinburgh, United Kingdom	2008-11
Chartered Accountant (CA)	

University of Bath – Bath, United Kingdom	2004-07
Bachelor of Science in Economics and Politics	

Conditionally Accepted Manuscripts

Huber, J., Holzknicht, A., Schwaiger, R., Blanco, E., Kirchler, M., et al. (including **Fawson, W.**)
Collective Evidence on Behavioral Interventions Targeting Carbon Pricing Support: A Many-
Designs Approach with 55 Studies

- Conditionally accepted at *Nature Human Behaviour*

Manuscripts under Revise and Resubmit

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of
Punishing Power-holders

- Currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*
- [Preprint](#)
- Featured in [Forbes](#)
- Featured in London Business School's [Think](#)

Manuscripts under Review

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. More Than a Consensus? A Social Relations Model Analysis
of Status

- Currently under review at the *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*
- [Preprint](#)

Fawson, W., Berman, J. Z., & Inesi, M. E. Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of
Disclosing Prosocial Behavior

- Currently under review at the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*
- [Preprint](#)

Working Papers

Basak, S., **Fawson, W.**, & Inesi, E. Venting Anger Downward in the Hierarchy is Inappropriate
and Undermines Perceived Leader Effectiveness (two studies complete; target *Journal of Applied
Psychology*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W. Deviating from the Status Consensus Reduces Psychological Safety (one study
complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Bechara, J. P., & Hays, N. A. Status Dissonance Leads to Subversive Status
Conflict (two studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Lount, R. The Motivational Consequences of Status Variance (three
studies complete; target *Academy of Management Journal*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. The Negative Effect of Narcissism on Dyadic Status
Exchanges (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Invited Research Talks

London Business School – London, United Kingdom	2025
NEOMA Business School – Rouen, France	2023

Chaired Symposia

Fawson, W. (2023). Innovations in Research in Hierarchy. Chaired symposium at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Conference Papers and Talks

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2026). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., Berman, J. Z., & Inesi, M. E. (2026) Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of Disclosing Prosocial Behavior. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., & Brion, S. (2025). Beyond the Individual: Dyadic Drivers of Status. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Hays, N. (2025). The Curvilinear Effect of Receiving Status Dissensus on Effort and Performance. In Zhu, G. (Organizer), *A Social Hierarchy Perspective on Navigating Interpersonal Relationships*. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Bechara, J. P.* (2025). The Effect of Status Deservedness on Dyadic Status Conflict in Groups. Paper presented at the 20th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Rotterdam, Netherlands (*presenter)*

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: Power Predicts the Reputational Consequences of Third-Party Punishment. Data Blitz presented at the 37th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Singapore*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Extraversion Congruence and Status Perception in Groups. In Fawson, W. (Organizer), *Innovations in Research on Hierarchy*. Paper presented at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 18th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Seattle, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 36th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Thessaloniki, Greece*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A.* (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Status Perception in Groups. Paper presented at the 21st *European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress, Katowice, Poland (*presenter)*

Awards

- Early Career Scholar, *International Association for Conflict Management* (2023)
- Nominated: Best Submission, *21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress* (2023)

Grants and Fellowships

- IESE Doctoral Grant 2021
- IESE Foundation Fellowship 2019
- IESE MBA Admissions Scholarship 2014

Teaching

- Lecturer, London Business School** – London, United Kingdom 2025-Present
- Personal Assessment & Development (Leadership); Masters in Finance
 - 2025-26 Instructor rating: 4.73/5 (based on 62 student surveys)
- Guest Lecturer, IESE Business School** – Barcelona, Spain 2021-Present
- Power & Influence; MBA/EMBA

Academic Service

- Service to IESE Business School** 2021-23
- Organised and chaired 48 one-hour Brown Bag seminars for speakers from IESE Business School, Bayes Business School, Esade and IE Business School
- Service to the Academy of Management** 2024-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
- Service to the International Association for Conflict Management** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
 - Speaker in 2024 Doctoral Student Workshop for the session “Managing the Interview Process”
- Service to the Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences

Work Experience

IESE Business School (www.iese.edu) – Barcelona, Spain Associate Director, Career Development Center	2017-19
• Devoted 300 hours to mentoring MBA students on breaking into consulting • Built case interview training content, delivered sessions to 150-student consulting club and conducted more than 100 practice interviews • Brought six new consulting firms to campus • Increased placements in top-three strategy consultancies from 28 to 46	
Monitor Deloitte (www.deloitte.com) – Amsterdam, Netherlands Strategy Consulting Manager (initially MBA Intern)	2015-17
• Developed growth strategy for a Polish energy provider • Led commercial activities in two départements at a French energy provider • Managed recruitment of MBAs for Deloitte's Dutch practice	
IHG Hotels & Resorts (www.ihgplc.com) – London, United Kingdom Corporate Finance Manager	2012-14
• Analysed the company's financial performance and prepared the CFO to discuss results and outlook in Executive Committee meetings each month • Coordinated the company's annual budget process • Worked closely with Investor Relations to manage external analyst coverage	
EY (www.ey.com) – London, United Kingdom Audit Senior Associate (initially Audit Associate)	2008-12
• Managed audits for a major UK-based telco • Supervised IPO on the New York Stock Exchange for a large software provider • Studied and passed exams to become a Chartered Accountant	

Languages

English: Mother Tongue
Italian, Spanish: Good

Interests

I enjoy going to the gym, running, and hiking. Once in a while I take on big challenges—including five Barcelona marathons, and cycling the 4,000km perimeter of the Iberian Peninsula.

References

Anneloes Raes
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Sebastien Brion
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